

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Sikh attitudes towards peace: Sikh teachings about the nature and importance of peace, including Guru Granth Sahib 671; how these may be understood and applied differently in the life of a Sikh.
4.2	The role of Sikhs in peacemaking: Sikh teachings about peacemaking; the importance for Sikhs of justice, forgiveness and reconciliation in peacemaking; how Sikhs work for peace today, the divergent approaches in what they do and why they try to work for peace, including Guru Granth Sahib 599 and links to situation ethics.
4.3	Sikh attitudes to conflict: Sikh teachings and responses to the nature and causes of conflict; Sikh responses to the problems conflict causes within society, including Zafarnama 22 and links to situation ethics; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes about the role of religion in the causes of conflict and Sikh responses to them.
4.4	Sikh attitudes to pacifism: Sikh teachings and responses to the nature and history of pacifism, including the goal of peace in Guru Granth Sahib 831; Sikh teachings about passive resistance and examples of its use within Sikhism, including the Akali movement.
4.5	Sikh attitudes to the Just War theory: Sikh teachings and responses to the nature and importance of the Just War theory; the conditions of a Just War within Sikhism, with specific reference to Dharam Yudh, including Dasam Granth 1133; divergent opinions on whether a Just War is possible for Sikhs today, including the application of ethical theories such as situation ethics.
4.6	Sikh attitudes to Holy War: Sikh teachings about war and peace as shown in the Guru Granth Sahib; Sikh teachings about war with specific reference to the concept of the saint-soldier, including Bhai Nand's Tankah Nama, and teachings about not killing and when fighting is a person's duty; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes towards Holy War and Sikh responses to them.
4.7	Sikh attitudes to weapons of mass destruction (WMD): Sikh teaching and responses to the problems and benefits of WMD; Sikh attitudes towards the use of such weapons, including the possible damage to the earth and its importance in Guru Granth Sahib 146; non-religious attitudes (including atheist and Humanist) and the application of ethical theories (such as utilitarianism) which support the acquisition of weapons of mass destruction, and Sikh responses to them.
4.8	Sikh responses to issues surrounding conflict: Sikh teachings and responses to the nature of problems involved in conflict – violence, war and terrorism, including links to the Five Thieves and Guru Granth Sahib 1330; how Sikhs have worked to overcome these issues; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) views towards the issues surrounding conflict and Sikh responses to them.

Paper 2: Area of Study 2 – Religion, Peace and Conflict

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 102 marks.
- Students must answer all sections and all questions on the chosen religion. The religion must be different for each area of study.
- The paper may include short open, open response and extended writing questions.
- The paper will assess spelling, punctuation and grammar (SPaG) and use of specialist terminology and these will contribute a minimum of 5% of marks towards the overall weighting for this paper.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Synopticity will be assessed where students are required to bring together their knowledge and understanding of religion from across the course of study.

Sample assessment materials

Sample papers and mark schemes can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Religious Studies B* Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.

Area of Study 3: Religion, Philosophy and Social Justice

The focus of this area of study is on Religion, Philosophy and Social Justice; this is one of three areas of study of which students must complete two.

For this area of study, students must study all four content sections in relation to one religion:

- 1 Beliefs in God
- 2 Philosophy of Religion
- 3 Living the Religious Life